RAG CHUNKABLE TEXT CORPUS: DOC 02

Proteas World Cup Campaigns & Tactical Log (2021–2024)

Match telemetry, tournament finishes, key statistical contributors, and tactical phases.

Document Identifier: CSA-TOURN-LOG-2021-2024 | **Vector Target:** Ground-truth data for tournament match logs, bowler strike rates, batting collapse analyses, and campaign finishes.

1. Global Tournament Results Summary

Across four ICC global men's events between 2021 and 2024, South Africa experienced an evolution from group-stage net-run-rate eliminations to reaching their first-ever senior men's World Cup final.

Tournament	Stage Reached	Win / Loss	Campaign Defining Moment
2021 T20 World Cup (UAE)	Super 12	4 W – 1 L	Failed to qualify for semi-finals on Net Run Rate (+0.739 vs AUS +1.216).
2022 T20 World Cup (AUS)	Super 12	2 W – 2 L (1 NR)	13-run upset defeat to Netherlands at Adelaide Oval eliminated squad.
2023 ODI World Cup (IND)	Semi-Finals	7 W – 3 L	Scored 428/5 vs SL (highest WC total); lost semi-final by 3 wickets to AUS.
2024 T20 World Cup (USA/WI)	Runners-Up (Final)	8 W – 1 L	Won 8 consecutive games to reach final; defeated by India by 7 runs in Barbados.

2. Tactical Deep-Dive: 2023 ICC Men's Cricket World Cup (India)

Under coach Rob Walter, the Proteas adopted a bat-first strategy, capitalizing on power-hitting through Quinton de Kock (4 centuries, 594 runs) and Heinrich Klaasen (middle-overs strike rate of 144.3). When batting first, South Africa averaged 373 runs per innings during the group phase.

However, tactical vulnerabilities emerged when chasing totals, highlighted by a collapse to 83 all out against India at Kolkata. Gerald Coetzee emerged as South Africa's breakout fast-bowler of the tournament, taking 20 wickets with high-effort middle-overs enforcer spells.

3. Historic Campaign: 2024 ICC Men's T20 World Cup (USA & West Indies)

Captained by Aiden Markram, the 2024 tournament marked the first time any senior South African men's team progressed to a World Cup final. The campaign was defined by bowling discipline on difficult drop-in pitches in New York followed by tight run-defending matches in the Caribbean.

Fixture / Opponent	Scoreline	Key Match MVP	Tactical Turning Point
Group Stage vs BAN	SA 113/6 def BAN 109/7	Heinrich Klaasen (46)	Defended 113 at Nassau County; Maharaj bowled final over conceding <11 runs.
Super 8 vs ENG	SA 163/6 def ENG 156/6	Quinton de Kock (65)	Jofra Archer hit for 21 in powerplay; Rabada executed 19th over conceding 4 runs.
Semi-Final vs AFG	AFG 56 all out; SA 60/1	Marco Jansen (3/16)	Jansen and Rabada bowled out Afghanistan for 56 on Brian Lara Stadium pitch.
Final vs IND	IND 176/7 def SA 169/8	Virat Kohli (IND, 76)	Klaasen hit 52 off 27; SA required 30 off 30 balls before Bumrah/Pandya restricted chase.

4. Key Player Tournament Aggregate Metrics

Across the 2024 tournament, Anrich Nortje established an economy rate of 5.74 while taking 15 wickets, frequently deployed as first-change bowler. Kagiso Rabada delivered 14 wickets, with his death-overs economy reading 6.88. Wicketkeeper-batter Quinton de Kock led the team's tournament run tally with 243 runs at a strike rate of 140.46 before confirming his retirement from international T20s.

RAG Evaluation Ground Truth Note: South Africa won 8 consecutive matches in the 2024 Men's T20 World Cup prior to the final against India. This set the Proteas' longest winning streak in ICC World Cup history.